VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ■■ □□□

*Hang clan · Mai's husband; father of Chao and Gao · cannot swim*

**Rally the Village**

Once per season, free (it costs Chai no action), while Hope is 3 or more and not in Winter: one villager who has not acted yet this season takes 1 extra action.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Soul Lock · Silver Bar



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ●●● ○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■ □□□

*Vang clan · The village teacher, Chai's oldest friend · cannot swim*

**Talk Our Way Past**

Once per season, when soldiers find the party (not the River Patrol), Tou speaks to them in Lao: draw a Fortune card, on 7 or more there is no fight.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Book · Translator



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ■ □□□□

*Hang clan · Chai's wife; mother of Chao and Gao · cannot swim*

**Hidden Harvest**

Once per season, as an action, where anything grows this season: +4 Food, and no one sees her.

AFFINITY ITEMS Hoe · Knife



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ● ○○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ■■■ □□

*Hang clan · cannot swim*

**Runner**

Once per season, as an action that eats no Food: Chao runs ahead and reveals 1 hidden place next to the party, the one farthest ahead. The party's next Travel needs no Danger draw: he has seen the way.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Slingshot · Tub Luj



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ● ○○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ■■ □□□

*Hang clan · Daughter of Chai and Mai; Chao's little sister · cannot swim*

**Hush**

Once per season, when a noise or foraging draw would bring soldiers, Gao keeps everyone silent in the leaves: the soldiers pass by.

AFFINITY ITEMS Doll · Rocks



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆◆ ◇◇ DEF ■ □□□□

*Lee clan · Mai's younger sister*

**The Hunt**

Once per season, free (it costs Sheng no action; not in Winter): draw a Fortune card. On 6 or more, +4 Food. On 5 or less the shot is heard: an Easy fight.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Bow · Hmong Gun



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■ □□

*Xiong clan · The blacksmith; Pao's cousin · cannot swim*

**Bamboo Armor**

Once per season, as an action: make a Bamboo Armor (body, Armor 1) for a villager with a free body slot. It falls apart after it has stopped 2 bullets.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Hammer · Sharpening Stone



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆◆ ◇◇◇ DEF ■■ □□□

*Yang clan · The shaman; Pa's nephew · cannot swim*

**Spirits Are Here**

Once per season, as an action: look at the top 3 cards of this place, put any Danger or Nothing cards on the bottom, then search here once with no noise.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Cloth Mask · Chu Neej



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ●● ○○○ ATK ◆ ◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■ □□

*Thao clan*

**River Man**

Once per season, as an action, where there is water (stream, bamboo, caves, jungle, fields, Lao village, riverbank, hamlet, ferry): +4 Food. At the river, one child, elder, sick or wounded villager crosses with him: 3 better on the current.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Scythe · Carrying Basket



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 1 of 104

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Mai

RICE FARMER, MOTHER OF TWO

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◆◇◇ DEF ■□□□□

*Hang clan · Chai's wife; mother of Chao and Gao · cannot swim*

**Every Grain**

Always on. Mai's Forage finds 3 more Food wherever anything grows.

AFFINITY ITEMS Hoe Knife



VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Tou

TEACHER WHO READS THAI AND LAO

HP ●●●○○ ATK ◆◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

*Vang clan · The village teacher, Chai's oldest friend · cannot swim*

**Reads the Signs**

Always on. Tou's own searches look at 6 cards and keep 1 (the rest go to the bottom). The first search each season by anyone else looks at 2 and keeps 1.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Book Translator



VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Chai

SENGLAO IN EXILE

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

*Hang clan · Mai's husband; father of Chao and Gao · cannot swim*

**Keeps the Council**

Always on. The council is offered 3 laws each Winter instead of 2, and every law it adopts gives Hope +1. Every Winter, if Hope is 1 or 0, Hope +1.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Soul Lock Silver Bar



VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Sheng

CROSSBOW HUNTER

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◆◇◇ DEF ■□□□□

*Lee clan · Mai's younger sister*

**Fresh Meat**

Always on. Sheng's Forage finds 2 more Food wherever anything grows: snares, birds, fish traps. While Sheng holds a quiet weapon (bow, crossbow, spear, slingshot) the party fires first in every fight.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Bow Hmong Gun



VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Gao

KID, LITTLE MOTHER

HP ●○○○○ ATK ◆◆◆◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

*Hang clan · Daughter of Chai and Mai; Chao's little sister · cannot swim*

**Quiet Hands**

Always on. Gao is never spotted while foraging, and her searches make no noise. Everyone else's noise is 2 lower.

AFFINITY ITEMS Doll Rocks



VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Chao

KID, MESSAGE RUNNER

HP ●○○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■■□□

*Hang clan · Son of Chai and Mai; Gao's big brother · cannot swim*

**Lookout**

Always on. The party is never ambushed: when soldiers find you or catch you foraging, you shoot back from the first clash.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Slingshot Tub Luj



VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Pao

FISHERMAN-FARMER, STRONG SWIMMER

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■□□

*Thao clan · Chong's cousin by marriage*

**Strong Swimmer**

Always on. Pao's current draw is 2 better, and anyone swept away after Pao is across is pulled out 2 better. Forage where there is water finds 2 more Food.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Scythe Carrying Basket



VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Meng

SHAMAN WHO READS THE BONES

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

*Yang clan · The shaman; Pa's nephew · cannot swim*

**Reads the Bones**

Always on. Twice a year, when a Season card is drawn, Meng may put it on the bottom of the deck and draw another.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Cloth Mask Chu Neej



VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Chong

RAFT BUILDER

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■□□

*Xiong clan · The blacksmith; Pao's cousin · cannot swim*

**Builder**

Always on. A camp Chong builds is finished in one action, and at the river the party's raft is free.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Hammer Sharpening Stone



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 2 of 104

VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ● ○ ○ ○ ○ ATK ◆ ◆ ◇ ◇ ◇ DEF ■ ■ ■ □ □

*Hang clan · Chai's father; the grandfather* *cannot swim*

**The Old Road**

Once per season, when the party Travels, Blong leads them by an old path: no Danger draw, and they gather 1 more Food on the way.

AFFINITY ITEMS Cane Ring



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ● ● ○ ○ ○ ATK ◆ ◆ ◆ ◇ ◇ DEF ■ □ □ □ □

*Her clan · Bao's husband, home from the army* *cannot swim*

**Ready for Battle**

Once per season, when a fight starts (not the River Patrol): the party has +2 ATK for that fight.

AFFINITY ITEMS

M-16 Hmong Knife



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ● ● ○ ○ ○ ATK ◆ ◆ ◇ ◇ ◇ DEF ■ ■ □ □ □

*Moua clan · The doctor; Lee's son-in-law* *cannot swim*

**Field Surgery**

Once per season, after a fight: the most wounded survivor heals 1 wound on the spot.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Medicine Box Scalpel



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ● ● ○ ○ ○ ATK ◆ ◆ ◇ ◇ ◇ DEF ■ ■ □ □ □

*Vue clan · The medicine woman; Kong's mother-in-law* *cannot swim*

**Fever Bark**

Once per season, free (it costs Lee no action): cure one Sick villager and make a Healing Salve (HP +3, next fight).

AFFINITY ITEMS

Herbs Bandages



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ● ● ○ ○ ○ ATK ◆ ◇ ◇ ◇ ◇ DEF ■ ■ ■ □ □

*Lor clan · Cheng's wife, the tailor* *cannot swim*

**Winter Clothes**

Once a year, free, in Fall or Winter: everyone draws 6 better at this Winter's Toll.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Needles Paj Ntaub



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ● ● ○ ○ ○ ATK ◆ ◇ ◇ ◇ ◇ DEF ■ ■ ■ □ □

*Cha clan · The singer; Tou's niece* *cannot swim*

**Sing at Night**

Once per season, free (it costs Ka no action): Ka sings kwv txhiaj by the fire. Hope +1, and the most wounded villager heals 1.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Qeej Tsaaj Nplaim



VILLAGER · SIDE A CHAO FA

HP ● ● ○ ○ ○ ATK ◆ ◆ ◇ ◇ ◇ DEF ■ ■ □ □ □

*Yang clan · Meng's aunt, a widow* *cannot swim*

**Call the Soul Back**

Once a year, when a villager would die in a fight, Pa calls their soul back: they live with 1 HP.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Joss Paper Incense Sticks



SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM

**Soul Lock**

+2 DEF for Chai; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Chai's item (Senglao (Mayor))

PACK

A soul lock of ancestral origin.

*Families hid silver neck rings under the floor when they fled.*



SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM

**Book**

+2 DEF for Tou; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Tou's item (Teacher)

PACK

An old self-defense book of martial arts.

*The village school was abandoned with its books on the shelf.*



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 3 of 104

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Kong
MEDIC TRAINED AT SAM THONG

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

*Moua clan · The doctor; Lee's son-in-law* *cannot swim*

### Field Medic

Always on. Every Rest heals 1 more wound, and when Kong nurses the Sick, the fever always breaks.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Medicine Box · Scalpel

ENDINGS P. 28 VILLAGER · 12/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Cheng
SGU RADIO OPERATOR

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◆◇◇ DEF ■□□□□

*Her clan · Bao's husband, home from the army* *cannot swim*

### Return Fire

Always on. When the party is ambushed, it still shoots back in the first clash.

AFFINITY ITEMS

M-16 · Hmong Knife

ENDINGS P. 26 VILLAGER · 11/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Blong
ELDER WHO KNOWS THE OLD ROADS

HP ●○○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■■□□

*Hang clan · Chai's father; the grandfather* *cannot swim*

### Knows the Hills

Always on. Every Danger draw when the party Travels is 2 better.

AFFINITY ITEMS Cane · Ring

ENDINGS P. 24 VILLAGER · 10/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Ka
KWV TXHIAJ SINGER

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■□□

*Cha clan · The singer; Tou's niece* *cannot swim*

### Songs at Night

Always on. Hope never falls below 2, and at the start of every Winter her New Year songs give Hope +1.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Qeej · Tsaaj Nplaim

ENDINGS P. 34 VILLAGER · 15/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Bao
TAILOR OF WARM CLOTHES

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◇◇◇◇ DEF ■■■□□

*Lor clan · Cheng's wife, the tailor* *cannot swim*

### Warm Clothes

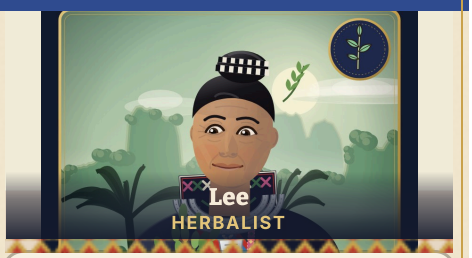
Always on. Everyone's Winter Toll is 3 better.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Needles · Paj Ntaub

ENDINGS P. 32 VILLAGER · 14/16

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA



## Lee
HERBALIST

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

*Vue clan · The medicine woman; Kong's mother-in-law* *cannot swim*

### Wild Greens

Always on. Lee's Forage finds 1 more Food wherever anything grows, every Rest heals 1 more wound, and when Lee nurses someone Sick the fever always breaks.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Herbs · Bandages

ENDINGS P. 30 VILLAGER · 13/16

SEARCH · HOME

# Village Ruins
CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

# Village Ruins
CHAO FA

VILLAGER · SIDE B CHAO FA

## Pa
SHAMAN, SOUL CALLER

HP ●●○○○ ATK ◆◆◇◇◇ DEF ■■□□□

### Calls the Soul Home

Always on. A death costs no Hope: Pa leads the rites. A fever Pa nurses always breaks. Once a game, the first villager the Toll would take is spared (hu plig). Winter at Hope 0 or 1: Hope +1. Once a year she reads the bones: put a drawn Season card under the deck, draw another.

AFFINITY ITEMS

Joss Paper · Incense Sticks

ENDINGS P. 36 VILLAGER · 16/16

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 4 of 104

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
**Doll**

+2 HP for Gao; +1 HP for anyone else.

Gao's item (Kid)

PACK

A Hmong doll.

*A child's doll left on a sleeping platform.*

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 3/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
**Hammer**

+2 ATK for Chong; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Chong's item (Blacksmith)

ONE HAND

An iron hammer.

*The village blacksmith's forge still has its tools.*

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 4/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
**Ring**

+1 HP, +1 DEF for Blong; +1 HP for anyone else.

Blong's item (Elder)

PACK

A very old ring with intricate carvings.

*An heirloom ring in a wooden box under the altar.*

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 5/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
**Needles**

+1 ATK, +1 DEF for Bao; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Bao's item (Tailor)

PACK

Needles used for sewing.

*Every house has needles and thread for paj ntaub.*

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 6/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
**Paj Ntaub**

+1 DEF, +1 HP for Bao; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Bao's item (Tailor)

BODY

Clothing that is used for show (flower cloth needlework).

*Flower cloth folded in a chest for the New Year.*

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 7/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM
**Su-Kah**

+1 DEF for anyone. Power: look at the top card of the search deck where you are.

PACK

A household talisman used to protect a house.

*The household spirit altar on the back wall of the house.*

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 8/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
**French Silver Coins**

Pays one boat seat when you have found a Boatman. Also +1 HP.

PACK

Old French Indochina silver piastres, the savings of a family.

*Families sewed coins into clothes or buried them under the house.*

MONEY

THE TRAIL VILLAGE RUINS · 9/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
**Iron Rice Pot**

The holder finds 1 extra Food each time they Forage. Also +1 HP.

PACK

A heavy iron pot for steaming rice and boiling greens.

*Every hearth had one, and few families could carry it.*

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 10/19

SEARCH · VILLA... CHAO FA

ITEM
**Village Flintlock**

A hunting gun: +2 ATK.

BOTH HANDS

A long flintlock musket made by a Hmong blacksmith.

*Hmong smiths made their own guns; one hung over many doorways.*

LOUD

THE TRAILVILLAGE RUINS · 11/19

SEARCH · HOME

## Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

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SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

Village Ruins

CHAO FA

ITEM
## Wood Axe

A tool and a weapon: +1 ATK, +1 DEF.

ONE HAND

A narrow-bladed axe for felling and splitting.

*Every house kept one by the woodpile.*

FOOD
## Rice left in a granary

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Village Ruins.

FOOD
## Rice left in a granary

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Village Ruins.

DANGER · EASY I
## Soldiers searching the ruins

**Easy fight** now. Win and search here 1 time **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Your own village or a neighbour's, burned or abandoned when the soldiers came. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SHELTER
## A standing house wall

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

CLUE
## A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

NOTHING
## Already picked over

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED
## A Letter from Nong Khai

**Key encounter, one step harder** than easy: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A cousin who crossed last year wrote where the camp is and who helped him. **It is in the headman's burned house, and soldiers are still searching the ruins.**

ITEM
## Hoe

+1 ATK, +1 DEF for Mai; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Mai's item (Farmer)

BOTH HANDS

A garden hoe.

*Hoes were left in the field huts at the end of the season.*



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 7 of 104

SEARCH · HOME

## Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

## Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

## Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

## Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

## Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

## Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

## Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

## Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HOME

## Village Ruins

CHAO FA

SEARCH · SWIDD… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Knife

+1 DEF, +1 HP for Mai; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Mai's item (Farmer)

ONE HAND

A garden knife.

*The field knife hangs in every field hut for clearing brush.*

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 2/17

SEARCH · SWIDD… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Slingshot

+2 ATK for Chao; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Chao's item (Kid)

ONE HAND

A slingshot made of wood and rubber bands.

*Boys guarded the ripening corn from birds with slingshots.*

QUIET

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 3/17

SEARCH · SWIDD… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Tub Luj

+2 DEF for Chao; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Chao's item (Kid)

PACK

A toy circular object that can be thrown (Hmong spinning top).

*Children spun tops on the packed earth by the field huts while their parents worked.*

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 4/17

SEARCH · SWIDD… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Scythe

+2 ATK for Pao; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Pao's item (Farmer)

BOTH HANDS

A garden scythe.

*Harvest tools stored in the granary by the field.*

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 5/17

SEARCH · SWIDD… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Carrying Basket (Kwb)

+2 DEF for Pao; +1 DEF for anyone else.

Pao's item (Farmer)

PACK

A kwb used to carry items and vegetables from the farm.

*Carrying baskets are left at the field hut, ready for harvest.*

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 6/17

SEARCH · SWIDD… CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM

## Water Buffalo

+1 DEF for anyone. Power: discard a card to gain 1 Food (1 action).

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A water buffalo used to till rice fields.

*A buffalo left in a burned field. It can be slaughtered for meat (4 Food, but -1 Hope).*

ANIMAL

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 7/17

SEARCH · SWIDD… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Gourd Water Bottle

Clean boiled water: the holder draws 1 better at the Toll. Also +1 HP.

PACK

A dried gourd that carries water.

*Gourds grew on the field fences and carried water to the fields.*

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 8/17

SEARCH · SWIDD… CHAO FA

SUPPLIES

## Sack of Seed Rice

Gain 3 Food when found. (Then discard it.)

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A sack of rice kept back for next year's planting.

*Seed rice was stored in the field granary.*

USED SIDE

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 9/17

SEARCH · SWIDD… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Machete

A tool and a weapon: +2 ATK.

ONE HAND

A heavy field blade for clearing brush.

*Left in a field hut when the family ran.*

THE TRAILSWIDDEN FIELDS · 10/17

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 9 of 104

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

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CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Swidden Fields

CHAO FA

SEARCH · SWIDD... CHAO FA

FOOD

## Ripe corn and pumpkins

**+2 Food now. Then discard this card.**

Something to eat in the Swidden Fields.

THE TRAIL SWIDDEN FIELDS · 11/17

SEARCH · SWIDD... CHAO FA

FOOD

## Ripe corn and pumpkins

**+1 Food now. Then discard this card.**

Something to eat in the Swidden Fields.

THE TRAIL SWIDDEN FIELDS · 12/17

SEARCH · SWIDD... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

## A patrol burning the fields

**Medium fight now. Win and search here 2 times in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).**

Hillside fields of upland rice and corn, cleared by slash-and-burn. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL SWIDDEN FIELDS · 13/17

SEARCH · SWIDD... CHAO FA

REMEDY

## Ginger and herbs from the garden

**Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the next fight.**

Rest, medicine or care.

THE TRAIL SWIDDEN FIELDS · 14/17

SEARCH · SWIDD... CHAO FA

NOTHING

## Burned

**No effect. Discard this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.**

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAIL SWIDDEN FIELDS · 15/17

SEARCH · SWIDD... CHAO FA

ESCAPE

## Smoke From the Fields

**Keep in hand. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, no fight.**

A way past the soldiers in the Swidden Fields.

THE TRAIL SWIDDEN FIELDS · 16/17

SEARCH · SWIDD... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## Talk of the Road South

**Key encounter, one step harder than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight one step up). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.**

Farmers in the field huts know which paths the soldiers watch. **The farmers will talk, but their own children are hungry.**

THE TRAIL SWIDDEN FIELDS · 17/17

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Bow

**+2 ATK for Sheng; +1 ATK for anyone else.**

Sheng's item (Hunter)

BOTH HANDS

A bow used to hunt pheasants and small animals.

*Hunters kept bows in their ridge-top shelters.*

QUIET

THE TRAIL PINE RIDGE · 1/14

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Hmong Gun

**+3 ATK for Sheng; +2 ATK for anyone else.**

Sheng's item (Hunter)

BOTH HANDS

A gun with a very long barrel, used to hunt small game.

*Long flintlock hunting guns were hidden in hunting shelters.*

LOUD

THE TRAIL PINE RIDGE · 2/14

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 11 of 104

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Swidden Fields**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Swidden Fields**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Swidden Fields**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Swidden Fields**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Swidden Fields**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Swidden Fields**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Pine Ridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Pine Ridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Swidden Fields**

CHAO FA

ITEM

## Cane

**+2 DEF for Blong; +1 DEF for anyone else.**

Blong's item (Elder)

ONE HAND

A solid wooden cane for the elderly.

*A straight walking stick cut from the ridge forest.*

LEGENDARY ITEM

## Horse

**+1 HP for anyone. Power: look at the top card of the search deck where you are.**

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A mountain pony.

*A pony carries three loads and cannot enter the caves or cross the river. It can be slaughtered for meat.*

ANIMAL

ITEM

## Crossbow (hneev)

**Hunting: the holder finds 1 extra Food when they Forage. Also +2 ATK.**

BOTH HANDS

A Hmong hunting crossbow with bamboo bolts.

*Hunters kept crossbows in their ridge-top shelters.*

QUIET

ITEM

## Pine-Resin Torch

**When the holder Searches, look at 2 cards and keep 1 (put the other on the bottom).**

ONE HAND

A bundle of pine splinters soaked in resin.

*Pine pitch burns slowly; hunters lit their way with it.*

ITEM

## Hunting Spear

**Keeps danger at arm's length: +1 ATK, +1 DEF.**

BOTH HANDS

An iron spearhead bound to a bamboo shaft.

*Hunters kept spears for wild pig in their ridge shelters.*

QUIET

FOOD

## Wild mushrooms and a bird

**+2 Food now. Then discard this card.**

Something to eat in the Pine Ridge.

FOOD

## Wild mushrooms and a bird

**+1 Food now. Then discard this card.**

Something to eat in the Pine Ridge.

DANGER · EASY I

## A tiger on the ridge

**Easy fight now. Win and search here 1 time in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).**

High, cool pine forest along the ridgeline above the villages. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SHELTER

## A hunter's shelter

**Keep in hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the next fight.**

A safe place to make a stand.



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 13 of 104

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

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SEARCH · THE HILLS

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SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Pine Ridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

NOTHING

## Nothing but pine needles

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAIL PINE RIDGE · 12/14

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

ESCAPE

## A Hidden Path

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Pine Ridge.

THE TRAIL PINE RIDGE · 13/14

SEARCH · PINE R... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

## Signal Fires

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than easy: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Resistance fighters light fires on the ridges to mark the safe way down. **The fires are lit only after dark, and the patrols watch the ridges too.**

THE TRAIL PINE RIDGE · 14/14

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Army Blanket

The holder draws 1 better at the Winter Toll. Also +1 DEF.

PACK

A heavy wool blanket from the war years.

*Blankets came in supply drops to the hill airstrips.*

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Transistor Radio

Look at the next Season card at any time.

PACK

A battery radio.

*Left in the radio hut at the strip. Radios carried news of patrols and of the camps in Thailand. Once a season, look at the top Season card and put it back.*

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Cargo Parachute

A dry tent: the holder draws 1 better at the Winter Toll. Also +1 DEF.

PACK

A nylon cargo parachute, white or striped.

*Parachutes from rice drops lay snagged in the trees around the strips; families made tents and clothes from them.*

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Steel Helmet

Armor 1: stops the first damage that would go to the wearer in each fight. +1 DEF. Also +1 DEF.

HEAD

An American steel helmet from the war years.

*Dropped with other supplies at the hill airstrips.*

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Flak Vest

Armor 1: stops the first damage that would go to the wearer in each fight. +1 DEF. Also +1 DEF.

BODY

A padded vest left by an aircrew.

*Abandoned in a shed when the airstrip was evacuated.*

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG ... CHAO FA

FOOD

## A torn sack of air-dropped rice

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Long Tieng Airstrip.

THE TRAILLONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Pine Ridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Pine Ridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Pine Ridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

FOOD

## A torn sack of air-dropped rice

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Long Tieng Airstrip.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

## Soldiers watching the strip

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The long dirt runway of Long Tieng, the Hmong army's old headquarters, between the karst hills. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

SHELTER

## A burned-out supply hut

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

NOTHING

## Bare red earth

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · LONG … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · ON THE FALLEN

## A Pilot's River Chart

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: take it, then his comrades ambush you at this place's level. Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

An old air chart with the Mekong fords marked in pencil. **It is in the pocket of a dead soldier by the burned huts. His patrol is close.**

THE TRAIL LONG TIENG AIRSTRIP

SEARCH · BAMB… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Tsaaj Nplaim

+2 HP for Ka; +1 HP for anyone else.

Ka's item (Singer)

PACK

An instrument used to court people.

*A leaf or bamboo-reed courting instrument made in the grove.*

THE TRAIL BAMBOO FOREST · 1/13

SEARCH · BAMB… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Bamboo Float Tubes

The holder draws 2 better crossing the river.

PACK

Sealed lengths of giant bamboo tied together.

*Non-swimmers tied bamboo tubes under their arms to cross the Mekong.*

FLOAT

THE TRAIL BAMBOO FOREST · 2/13

SEARCH · BAMB… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Bundle of Raft Poles

Lets the party build a raft without giving up 2 items.

SHARED BY THE PARTY

Long dry bamboo poles, cut and bundled.

*Giant bamboo floats well and was lashed into rafts.*

RAFT

THE TRAIL BAMBOO FOREST · 3/13

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 17 of 104

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Long Tieng Airstrip**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Bamboo Forest**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Bamboo Forest**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Bamboo Forest**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

ITEM
## Snare Traps

The holder finds 1 extra Food when they Forage.

PACK

Wire and cord snares for birds and small animals.

*Hunters set snares on the rat and bird trails through the bamboo.*

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 4/13

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

FOOD
## Bamboo shoots

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Bamboo Forest.

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 5/13

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

FOOD
## Bamboo shoots

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Bamboo Forest.

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 6/13

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

DANGER · EASY I
## A militia patrol on the path

**Easy fight** now. Win and search here 1 time **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Dense groves of giant bamboo in the valleys below the ridges. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 7/13

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

REMEDY
## Clean bamboo water

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 8/13

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

NOTHING
## Only old bamboo

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 9/13

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

AMBUSH · EASY I
## Soldiers waiting in the grove

**Easy fight** now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

Dense groves of giant bamboo in the valleys below the ridges.

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 10/1

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

ESCAPE
## A Tunnel Through the Bamboo

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Bamboo Forest.

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 11/13

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · MINED
## Blazes on the Bamboo

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than easy: take it; everyone draws a **Fortune card**, 1 to 4 = **2 wounds** (Dog: only 1). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Families who went before cut marks in the bamboo to show the path. **The soldiers found the marks too, and mined the path.**

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 12/13

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 19 of 104

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

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SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

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SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Bamboo Forest

CHAO FA

SEARCH · BAMB... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## A Raft-Maker's Word

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than easy: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A man cutting bamboo says which stream carries rafts down to the Mekong. **He has a family to feed and will not say for nothing.**

THE TRAILBAMBOO FOREST · 13/1

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Herbs

+2 HP for Lee; +1 HP for anyone else.

Lee's item (Medicine Woman)

PACK

Various herbs that smell sweet.

*Medicine plants grow wild in the deep forest.*

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM

## Dog

+1 HP for anyone. Power: discard a card to gain 1 Food (1 action).

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A village dog used to guard a house.

*A village dog that ran into the forest finds you.*

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Rattan Rope

The holder draws 1 better crossing the river (tied to the raft or the others). Also +1 DEF.

PACK

Rope twisted from split rattan cane.

*Rattan vines grow in the deep forest.*

FLOAT

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Dropped Rifle

A strong weapon: +3 ATK.

BOTH HANDS

A rifle left beside the trail with a few rounds.

*Soldiers of the Secret Army dropped heavy gear as they fled through the forest.*

LOUD

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Rattan Shield

Armor 1 and +1 DEF. Also +1 DEF.

ONE HAND

A round shield of woven rattan, hardened over smoke.

*Made in the forest from split rattan cane.*

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

FOOD

## Wild yams and fruit

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Phou Khao Khouay Jungle.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

FOOD

## Wild yams and fruit

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Phou Khao Khouay Jungle.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU ... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

## A sweep through the jungle

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Tall rain forest on the sandstone hills between the mountains and the Mekong, with leeches and little light. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 21 of 104

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Bamboo Forest**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 22 of 104

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

## A sweep through the jungle

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Tall rain forest on the sandstone hills between the mountains and the Mekong, with leeches and little light. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

SHELTER

## A hidden hollow

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

REMEDY

## Healing leaves

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Guide

Keep this card. Every Danger draw when the party moves is 3 better.

A Lao farmer, or a Hmong man who knows the trails, offers to lead you.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

NOTHING

## Lost in the undergrowth

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

AMBUSH · MEDIUM II

## An ambush in the undergrowth

**Medium fight** now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

Tall rain forest on the sandstone hills between the mountains and the Mekong, with leeches and little light.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ESCAPE

## Monsoon Rain

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Phou Khao Khouay Jungle.

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

## A Resistance Courier

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A runner tells you where and when to meet the people who can help. **He is pinned down in a gully by a patrol. Free him and he will talk.**

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## A Soldier Who Deserted

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

He fought for the other side and knows where the patrols sleep. **He wants silver, or a gun, before he trusts you.**

THE TRAILPHOU KHAO KHOUAY JU

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Khao Khouay Jungle**

CHAO FA

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 24 of 104

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
## Silver Bar

**+2 HP for Chai; +1 HP for anyone else.**

Chai's item (Senglao (Mayor))

PACK

A silver bar used in bartering and trade.

*Families hid their silver in caves before they fled.*

MONEY

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 1/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
## Cloth Mask

**+1 HP, +1 DEF for Meng; +1 HP for anyone else.**

Meng's item (Shaman)

HEAD

A cloth mask used to cover your face.

*The shaman's things were carried to the caves for safekeeping.*

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 2/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
## Chu Neej

**+2 DEF for Meng; +1 DEF for anyone else.**

Meng's item (Shaman)

PACK

A jingle set made of iron and brass.

*Shaman's rattles were hidden with other sacred things in caves.*

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 3/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
## Hmong Knife

**+2 ATK for Cheng; +1 ATK for anyone else.**

Cheng's item (Soldier)

ONE HAND

A Hmong knife used in butchering animals and general use.

*Resistance fighters cached knives and tools in caves.*

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 4/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
## Medicine Box

**+2 HP for Kong; +1 HP for anyone else.**

Kong's item (Doctor)

PACK

A medicine box.

*An aid post of the resistance kept its medicine box in a cave.*

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 5/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
## Qeej

**+1 DEF, +1 HP for Ka; +1 DEF for anyone else.**

Ka's item (Singer)

PACK

An instrument used to help call spirits.

*A qeej carried up to the caves so the funeral songs would not be lost.*

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 6/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
## Incense Sticks

**+1 HP, +1 DEF for Pa; +1 DEF for anyone else.**

Pa's item (Shaman)

PACK

Incense sticks used to help call spirits.

*Incense left at a cave shrine.*

USED SIDE

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 7/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
## Old Carbine

**A strong weapon: +3 ATK.**

BOTH HANDS

An American carbine from the Secret Army years.

*Soldiers of the resistance cached weapons in caves.*

LOUD

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 8/1

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

ITEM
## Army Poncho

**Dry in the monsoon: the holder draws 1 better at the Toll. Also +1 DEF.**

BODY

A rubberised rain poncho.

*Left with other supplies in a resistance cave.*

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 9/1

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 25 of 104

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

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SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

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SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SUPPLIES
## Hidden Rice Cache

Gain 4 Food when found. (Then discard it.)

SHARED BY THE PARTY

Jars of rice hidden at the back of a cave.

*Families stored rice in caves to hide it from soldiers.*

⊘ USED SIDE

FOOD
## Rice hidden in a jar

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Limestone Caves.

FOOD
## Rice hidden in a jar

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Limestone Caves.

DANGER · MEDIUM II
## Soldiers search the caves

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Caves in the karst towers, dry inside even in the monsoon. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SHELTER
## A dry cave

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

REMEDY
## An aid-post first-aid kit

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.

NOTHING
## An empty cave

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

ESCAPE
## A Back Way Out

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Limestone Caves.

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED
## Names on the Cave Wall

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Families scratched their names and the way they went into the rock. **Soldiers are camped in the mouth of the cave.**



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 27 of 104

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Limestone Caves**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Limestone Caves**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Limestone Caves**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Limestone Caves**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Limestone Caves**

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CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Limestone Caves**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Limestone Caves**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Limestone Caves**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · LIMES… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## A Shaman's Blessing

**Key encounter, one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A txiv neeb calls the spirits to guide the family across the water. **The ceremony needs an offering: incense, paper money, a rooster, or rice.**

THE TRAILLIMESTONE CAVES · 19/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Translator

+2 HP for Tou; +1 HP for anyone else.

Tou's item (Teacher)

PACK

A guide used to help translate Hmong to Lao.

*Lowland traders kept Hmong-Lao word lists for doing business with hill people.*

DISGUISE

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 1/2

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Bandages

+1 HP, +1 DEF for Lee; +1 HP for anyone else.

Lee's item (Medicine Woman)

PACK

Crudely made bandages.

*Cloth bought or begged from lowland villagers.*

USED SIDE

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 2/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Joss Paper

+2 HP for Pa; +1 HP for anyone else.

Pa's item (Shaman)

PACK

Joss paper used as offerings for the dead.

*Spirit paper sold by lowland traders.*

USED SIDE

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 3/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM

## Rooster

+1 ATK for anyone. Power: look at the top card of the search deck where you are.

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A village rooster meant to wake people up.

*A rooster traded or caught in a lowland village.*

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 4/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Lao Clothes

Disguise: every Danger draw when the party moves is 2 better.

BODY

A Lao sarong and plain shirt.

*Dressing as lowland Lao helped families pass through villages and checkpoints.*

DISGUISE

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 5/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Bag of Salt

The holder finds 1 extra Food when they Forage (salted food lasts). Also +1 HP.

PACK

Coarse salt from the lowland salt wells.

*Highlanders bought salt from Lao traders; it keeps fish and meat.*

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 6/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Mosquito Net

The holder draws 1 better at the Toll.

PACK

A cotton mosquito net.

*Lowland traders sold nets; malaria killed many people in hiding.*

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 7/

SEARCH · LAO F… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Quinine Tablets

The holder draws 2 better at the Toll. Also +1 HP.

PACK

A small bottle of malaria tablets.

*Bought at a lowland market for silver.*

USED SIDE

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 8/

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

Limestone Caves

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Padded Cotton Jacket

Armor 1: stops the first damage that would go to the wearer in each fight. Warm: 1 better at the Toll.

BODY

A quilted jacket stuffed with kapok.

*Lowland tailors sold padded jackets for the cold season.*



SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

FOOD

## Sticky rice from a kind family

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Lao Farm Village.



SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

FOOD

## Sticky rice from a kind family

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Lao Farm Village.



SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

## Someone reports you

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

A lowland village of Lao rice farmers, on the way to the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.



SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

DANGER · EASY I

## Someone reports you

**Easy fight** now. Win and search here 1 time **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

A lowland village of Lao rice farmers, on the way to the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.



SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

REMEDY

## A village healer

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.



SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Guide

Keep this card. Every Danger draw when the party moves is 3 better.

A Lao farmer, or a Hmong man who knows the trails, offers to lead you.



SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.



SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

NOTHING

## Doors stay shut

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 31 of 104

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

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SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

AMBUSH · MEDIUM II

## A trap at the well

**Medium fight** now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

A lowland village of Lao rice farmers, on the way to the river.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 18

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

ESCAPE

## A Friendly Warning

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Lao Farm Village.

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 19

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## A Lao Friend's Promise

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A Lao farmer will hide you near the river on the night you cross. **He is risking his family. He asks for silver, or rice.**

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 20

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

## Market Gossip

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

At market they say which nights the river patrols change. **You must wait by the market until dark to hear it, where anyone could see you.**

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 21

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

## The Headman's Pass

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A stamped paper that lets a family walk the lowland roads. **The stamp is kept at the militia post at the edge of the village.**

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 22

SEARCH · LAO F... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

## A Monk at the Temple

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A Lao monk tells travellers which villages along the river are kind to strangers. **He will speak only after evening prayers, and the militia walks past the temple at dusk.**

THE TRAILLAO FARM VILLAGE · 23

SEARCH · HIN HE... CHAO FA

ITEM

## M-16

+3 ATK for Cheng; +2 ATK for anyone else.

Cheng's item (Soldier)

BOTH HANDS

An American-issued M-16.

*Rifles from the Secret Army were taken at checkpoints and left in army stores.*

LOUD

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 1/18

SEARCH · HIN HE... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Scalpel

+2 HP for Kong; +1 HP for anyone else.

Kong's item (Doctor)

PACK

A sharp scalpel.

*An army medic's kit dropped by the road.*

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 2/18

SEARCH · HIN HE... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Forged Travel Pass

Every Danger draw when the party moves is 2 better.

PACK

A stamped paper allowing travel to the river towns.

*Passes were bought, forged or taken at checkpoints.*

DISGUISE

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 3/18

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 33 of 104

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Lao Farm Village

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Hin Heup Bridge

CHAO FA

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 34 of 104

ITEM
## Captured Rifle

**A strong weapon: +3 ATK.**

BOTH HANDS

A rifle taken from an army store.

*Army posts along the roads kept weapons and ammunition.*

LOUD

SUPPLIES
## Army Rations

**Gain 3 Food when found. (Then discard it.)**

SHARED BY THE PARTY

Tins of fish and bags of rice.

*Supply trucks stopped at the checkpoint.*

USED SIDE

ITEM
## Army Body Armor

**Armor 2 and +1 DEF. Also +1 DEF.**

BODY

A heavy vest taken from an army store.

*The checkpoint stores held gear for the soldiers on the road.*

FOOD
## A dropped sack of rice

**+3 Food now. Then discard this card.**

Something to eat in the Hin Heup Bridge.

FOOD
## A dropped sack of rice

**+1 Food now. Then discard this card.**

Something to eat in the Hin Heup Bridge.

DANGER · HARD III
## The checkpoint guards

**Hard fight now. Win and search here 3 times in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).**

The road to Vientiane and the bridge over the Nam Lik, with an army checkpoint at its end. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

DANGER · HARD III
## The checkpoint guards

**Hard fight now. Win and search here 3 times in safety (skip Danger and Nothing cards).**

The road to Vientiane and the bridge over the Nam Lik, with an army checkpoint at its end. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

CLUE
## A Trail Map

**Turn face up every tile in the next row.**

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

NOTHING
## Too many soldiers

**No effect. Discard this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.**

Nothing useful this time.



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 35 of 104

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

AMBUSH · HARD III

## Shots from the ditch

**Hard fight** now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

The road to Vientiane and the bridge over the Nam Lik, with an army checkpoint at its end.

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 13/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

ESCAPE

## A Ditch by the Road

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Hin Heup Bridge.

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 14/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

## A Patrol Timetable

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than hard: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Overheard at the checkpoint: when the trucks come and go. **To hear it you must get close to the checkpoint itself.**

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 15/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## A Guard Who Looks Away

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than hard: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

One guard will let a family pass for a little silver. **Only for silver. If you will not pay, he calls the others.**

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 16/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · MINED

## A Burned-Out Truck

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than hard: take it; everyone draws a **Fortune card**, 1 to 4 = **2 wounds** (Dog: only 1). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

In the cab of a burned army truck, papers with the river posts marked. **The road shoulder around the truck is mined.**

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 17/1

SEARCH · HIN HE… CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## A Ride on a Logging Truck

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than hard: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A driver will hide a family under the logs as far as the river road. **He wants silver first. Without it he drives on, and he has seen your faces.**

THE TRAILHIN HEUP BRIDGE · 18/1

SEARCH · NAM X… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Rocks

+2 HP for Gao; +1 HP for anyone else.

Gao's item (Kid)

ONE HAND

A small shiny rock.

*Smooth bright stones from the streambed.*

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 1/15

SEARCH · NAM X… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Sharpening Stone

+1 ATK, +1 DEF for Chong; +1 ATK for anyone else.

Chong's item (Blacksmith)

PACK

A sharpening stone used to retouch items.

*The best whetstones are flat stones from a fast stream.*

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 2/15

SEARCH · NAM X… CHAO FA

LEGENDARY ITEM

## Fishing Pole

+1 ATK for anyone. Power: discard a card to gain 1 Food (1 action).

BOTH HANDS

A fishing pole used to catch fish.

*A bamboo rod left by a fisherman.*

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 3/15

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 37 of 104

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Hin Heup Bridge**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Nam Xan Valley**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Nam Xan Valley**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Nam Xan Valley**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

ITEM
## Cast Net

The holder finds 2 extra Food when they Forage.

PACK

A round weighted fishing net.

*Lowland fishermen leave nets drying on the rocks.*

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 4/15

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

ITEM
## Clay Water Jar

The holder draws 1 better at the Toll. Also +1 HP.

PACK

A jar for carrying and boiling water.

*Potters worked the clay banks of the streams.*

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 5/15

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

FOOD
## Fish and river crabs

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Nam Xan Valley.

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 6/15

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

FOOD
## Fish and river crabs

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Nam Xan Valley.

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 7/15

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

DANGER · EASY I
## A patrol at the ford

**Easy fight** now. Win and search here 1 time **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

A rocky stream running down into the Nam Xan, the river that meets the Mekong at Paksane. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 8/15

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

SHELTER
## An overhanging rock

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 9/15

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

CLUE
## A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 10/1

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

NOTHING
## Empty water

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 11/1

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK
## The Stream's Mouth

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than easy: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Follow the water down and it meets the Mekong at a quiet bend. **The bend can only be reached at night, when the fishermen have gone home.**

THE TRAILNAM XAN VALLEY · 12/1

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SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · ON THE FALLEN

## Footprints in the Mud

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than easy: take it, then his comrades ambush you at this place's level. Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Other families came this way, and recently. **The trail ends at a soldier dead in the reeds. In his pack is a list of the fords, and his unit is looking for him.**

THE TRAIL NAM XAN VALLEY · 13/1

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

## A Smugglers' Path

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than easy: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Salt and opium traders use a path through the reeds that the army does not know. **The traders guard their path, and they shoot first.**

THE TRAIL NAM XAN VALLEY · 14/1

SEARCH · NAM X... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## A Buffalo Boy's Shortcut

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than easy: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A boy herding buffalo knows a dry way through the paddies to the river. **He wants rice for his family before he will show you.**

THE TRAIL NAM XAN VALLEY · 15/1

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Truck Inner Tube

The holder draws 3 better crossing the river.

PACK

A patched rubber inner tube.

*Inner tubes were the best floats a family could find.*

FLOAT

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 1/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Driftwood Logs

Lets the party build a raft without giving up 2 items.

SHARED BY THE PARTY

Logs washed up on the bank.

*The Mekong leaves timber on every sandbar.*

RAFT

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 2/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

FOOD

## Mussels and river weed

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Mekong Reeds.

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 3/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

FOOD

## Mussels and river weed

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Mekong Reeds.

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 4/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

## A river patrol

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Reeds and mud flats on the Lao bank between Vientiane and Paksane, with Thailand across the water. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 5/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

REMEDY

## Rest by the water

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.

THE TRAIL MEKONG REEDS · 6/15

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

## Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

## Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

## Nam Xan Valley

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

## Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

## Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

## Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

## Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

## Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

## Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 7/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 8/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 9/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

NOTHING

## Mud and reeds

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 10/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

AMBUSH · MEDIUM II

## Rifles in the reeds

**Medium fight** now. Ambush: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in clash 1).

Reeds and mud flats on the Lao bank between Vientiane and Paksane, with Thailand across the water.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 11/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

ESCAPE

## Fog on the River

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Mekong Reeds.

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 12/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

## Lights on the Thai Bank

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

You can see the lamps of a Thai village. Now you know where to aim. **The lamps can only be seen after dark, from the open bank.**

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 13/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

## A Hidden Landing

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A gap in the reeds where rafts are put in at night. **A river patrol has found it and waits there.**

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 14/15

SEARCH · MEKO... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## A Boatman's Son

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A boy who helps his father ferry families knows which night they go. **His father will want silver or baht for a place on the list.**

THE TRAILMEKONG REEDS · 15/15

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 43 of 104

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

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SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Mekong Reeds

CHAO FA

ITEM
## Thai Baht Notes

Pays one boat seat when you have found a Boatman.

PACK

Paper money from across the river.

*Fishermen traded across the river and took baht for passage.*

MONEY

ITEM
## Bamboo Fish Trap

The holder finds 1 extra Food when they Forage.

PACK

A woven cone trap for fish.

*Every fishing family has a few.*

FOOD
## Dried fish

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Fishing Hamlet.

FOOD
## Dried fish

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Fishing Hamlet.

DANGER · MEDIUM II
## A fisherman turns you in

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

A few stilt houses of Lao fishermen with boats pulled up on the bank. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

SHELTER
## A friendly family hides you

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

CLUE
## A Boatman

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, each silver item (Silver Bar, Ring, Soul Lock, French Silver Coins, Thai Baht) buys one boat seat.

A fisherman who will ferry people across at night for silver.

CLUE
## A Boatman

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, each silver item (Silver Bar, Ring, Soul Lock, French Silver Coins, Thai Baht) buys one boat seat.

A fisherman who will ferry people across at night for silver.

CLUE
## A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 45 of 104

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Fishing Hamlet

CHAO FA

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

NOTHING
## No one answers

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 10/14

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

ESCAPE
## Under the Stilt Houses

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Fishing Hamlet.

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 11/14

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE
## The Fisherman's Signal

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

Three flashes of a torch from the far bank mean it is safe. **The fisherman wants paying for the signal. If you will not pay, he may go to the soldiers.**

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 12/14

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK
## A Night With No Moon

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

An old woman tells you when the next dark night will be. **She tells you only after you have waited with her through the night.**

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 13/14

SEARCH · FISHIN... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · ON THE FALLEN
## A Patrol Book in the Nets

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: take it, then his comrades ambush you at this place's level. Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A patrolman drowned in the nets. His book has the boat times. **His comrades are dragging the river for him.**

THE TRAIL FISHING HAMLET · 14/14

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

ITEM
## Dugout Canoe

Two people may cross by boat without paying a boatman.

SHARED BY THE PARTY

A narrow dugout canoe hidden in the reeds.

*The ferrymen kept small boats near the old landing.*

BOAT

THE TRAIL THA DEUA FERRY · 1/12

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

FOOD
## Rice from an empty guardhouse

+3 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Tha Deua Ferry.

THE TRAIL THA DEUA FERRY · 2/12

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

FOOD
## Rice from an empty guardhouse

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Tha Deua Ferry.

THE TRAIL THA DEUA FERRY · 3/12

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III
## The guard post

**Hard fight** now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The old ferry landing below Vientiane, where the boats to Nong Khai crossed, now a guarded army post. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL THA DEUA FERRY · 4/12

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 47 of 104

SEARCH · THE RIVER

**Fishing Hamlet**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

**Fishing Hamlet**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

**Fishing Hamlet**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

**Tha Deua Ferry**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

**Fishing Hamlet**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

**Fishing Hamlet**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

**Tha Deua Ferry**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

**Tha Deua Ferry**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

**Tha Deua Ferry**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III

## The guard post

**Hard fight** now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The old ferry landing below Vientiane, where the boats to Nong Khai crossed, now a guarded army post. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.



SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.



SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Safe Crossing Place

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, the current check is 3 better for everyone, and going down to the water 1 better.

A quiet stretch where the current is slower and the far bank is close.



SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Boatman

Keep it with this tile. When you cross from here, each silver item (Silver Bar, Ring, Soul Lock, French Silver Coins, Thai Baht) buys one boat seat.

A fisherman who will ferry people across at night for silver.



SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

NOTHING

## Searchlights

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.



SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

## The Guard Change

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than hard: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

For a few minutes after midnight, no one watches the landing. **You must get past the outer guards to see it.**



SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

## The Ferryman's Hut

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than hard: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

An old ferryman who lost his boat knows every sandbar between here and Thailand. **He comes back to his hut only at night, past the guard post.**



SEARCH · THA D... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · MINED

## A Boat Left Untied

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than hard: take it; everyone draws a **Fortune card**, 1 to 4 = **2 wounds** (Dog: only 1). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A small boat at the end of the old pier, if you can reach it. **The path to the pier is mined and lit.**



SEARCH · PLAIN ... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Bomb Casing Pot

+1 Food whenever the party forages.

PACK

Half a cluster-bomb casing, blackened by cooking fires.

*Families on the plain cooked in the halves of the bomb casings that lay everywhere.*



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 49 of 104

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE RIVER

Tha Deua Ferry

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

ITEM

## Drop Tarpaulin

The Winter Toll is 1 better for everyone.

PACK

A rotted supply-drop tarpaulin, still waterproof.

*Rice drops came wrapped in tarpaulin. A sheet of it keeps the rain off a shelter.*

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 2/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

ITEM

## Entrenching Tool

+1 ATK, +1 DEF for anyone.

ONE HAND

A folding army shovel.

*Dropped by a soldier on the plain. It digs a firing position or a grave.*

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 3/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

FOOD

## Rice from an abandoned paddy

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Plain of Jars.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 4/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

FOOD

## Frogs from the craters

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Plain of Jars.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 5/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

## A patrol on the open plain

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Open grassland around the great stone jars, cratered and littered with old bombs. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 6/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

DANGER · EASY I

## Militia at the jars

**Easy fight** now. Win and search here 1 time **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Open grassland around the great stone jars, cratered and littered with old bombs. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 7/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

OLD BOMBS

## Bomblets in the grass

Everyone draws a **Fortune card**: on 1 or 2, an old bomb, **2 wounds**. The Dog: only on a 1. Then discard this card.

Open grassland around the great stone jars, cratered and littered with old bombs.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 8/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

OLD BOMBS

## A crater field

Everyone draws a **Fortune card**: on 1 or 2, an old bomb, **2 wounds**. The Dog: only on a 1. Then discard this card.

Open grassland around the great stone jars, cratered and littered with old bombs.

THE TRAIL PLAIN OF JARS · 9/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

SHELTER

## A crater to lie in

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +1 DEF in the **next fight**.

A safe place to make a stand.

THE TRAILPLAIN OF JARS · 10/13

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 51 of 104

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

Plain of Jars

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

NOTHING
## Only the jars

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.

THE TRAILPLAIN OF JARS · 11/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

ESCAPE
## Across the Plain by Night

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Plain of Jars.

THE TRAILPLAIN OF JARS · 12/13

SEARCH · PLAIN … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE
## The Road Watcher's Word

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

An old man who watches the road knows which trucks carry soldiers. **He wants rice for his word.**

THE TRAILPLAIN OF JARS · 13/13

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ITEM
## Pahawh Primer

+1 DEF for anyone.

PACK

A hand-copied primer in the Pahawh script.

*The Chao Fa taught the script of Shong Lue Yang in their camps. The book is their mark and their memory.*

CHAO FA

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 1/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ITEM
## Field Dressing

Counts as medicine for nursing. Turn it face down when used.

PACK

A sealed army field dressing.

*Carried by every fighter on the mountain. Counts as medicine for nursing.*

USED SIDE

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 2/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ITEM
## Soldier's Map

Searching: look at one card more and choose.

PACK

A map case with a marked sheet of the Phou Bia massif.

*The mountain fighters marked the paths and the hiding places. Searches here look one card deeper.*

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 3/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

FOOD
## A hidden camp's rice

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Phou Bia Slopes.

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 4/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

FOOD
## Mountain roots

+1 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Phou Bia Slopes.

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 5/14

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III
## Soldiers climbing the mountain

**Hard fight** now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The high slopes of the biggest mountain in Laos, cold, steep and full of hiding families. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.

THE TRAILPHOU BIA SLOPES · 6/14

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 53 of 104

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Plain of Jars**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Plain of Jars**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE HILLS

**Plain of Jars**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

## A patrol on the ridge path

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

The high slopes of the biggest mountain in Laos, cold, steep and full of hiding families. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.



SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

THE CHAO FA

## The Chao Fa Take You In

A band of resistance fighters shares their fire and their rifles for a while. Your next 3 fights: the party has +3 ATK. Keep it face up and turn it after the third fight.

The high slopes of the biggest mountain in Laos, cold, steep and full of hiding families.

CHAO FA



SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Guide

Keep this card. Every Danger draw when the party moves is 3 better.

A Lao farmer, or a Hmong man who knows the trails, offers to lead you.



SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

REMEDY

## A night in a Chao Fa camp

**Keep in hand**. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest, medicine or care.



SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

NOTHING

## Cold, and nothing to eat

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.



SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

ESCAPE

## Cloud on the Mountain

**Keep in hand**. When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Phou Bia Slopes.



SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · GUARDED

## The Fighters' Trail

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: fight for it (Lao Clothes or a Travel Pass: **no step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

The Chao Fa know the way down to the river, and who is watching it. **Their camp is watched from below.**



SEARCH · PHOU … CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · ON THE FALLEN

## A Fighter's Last Word

**Key encounter**, **one step harder** than medium: take it, then his comrades ambush you at this place's level. Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A dying fighter names the crossing his family used. **He fell on the path, and the soldiers who shot him are close.**



SEARCH · VIENTI… CHAO FA

ITEM

## Ball of Opium

Money: pays a Boatman, a Price, a Trade or a shakedown. Or spend it: a **Sick** villager is not **Sick** for one Winter Toll.

PACK

A fist of raw opium wrapped in leaves.

*The cash crop of the mountains and the medicine chest of the sick. Money: it pays a Boatman, a Price or a Trade. Or spend it so a Sick villager is not Sick for one Winter Toll (it eases, it does not cure).*

MONEY



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 55 of 104

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

**Vientiane Plain**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE JUNGLE

**Phou Bia Slopes**

CHAO FA

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Lao Identity Card

Danger 1 better when you Travel. A disguise piece: with two in the party, no one looks twice.

PACK

A lowland Lao identity card with a stranger's photograph.

*On the plain everyone is asked for papers. A card, even a stranger's, gets the party past a glance.*

DISGUISE



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

ITEM

## Kerosene Lamp

Searching: look at one card more and choose.

PACK

A tin lamp with a little kerosene left.

*Light to search by, if you dare to show one.*



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

FOOD

## The market at dawn

+3 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Vientiane Plain.



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

FOOD

## Paddy rice and fish sauce

+2 Food now. Then discard this card.

Something to eat in the Vientiane Plain.



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III

## A checkpoint on the road

**Hard fight** now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Rice paddies, market towns and the road into the capital, a day from the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

DANGER · HARD III

## Soldiers searching a bus

**Hard fight** now. Win and search here 3 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Rice paddies, market towns and the road into the capital, a day from the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

DANGER · MEDIUM II

## Militia in the paddies

**Medium fight** now. Win and search here 2 times **in safety** (skip Danger and Nothing cards).

Rice paddies, market towns and the road into the capital, a day from the river. Militia and Pathet Lao patrols to 1976; the Lao army and Vietnamese units from 1977.



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

CLUE

## A Trail Map

Turn face up every tile in the next row.

A hand-drawn map of the paths to the river.



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

NOTHING

## Too many eyes

No effect. **Discard** this card. The deck gets thinner as you search.

Nothing useful this time.



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 57 of 104

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

ESCAPE

## A Monk's Blessing

**Keep in hand.** When soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: the party slips away, **no fight**.

A way past the soldiers in the Vientiane Plain.



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## A Trader's Route

**Key encounter, one step harder** than hard: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A market trader runs goods to the river and knows the quiet landings. **He sells to anyone, including the police.**



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · A PRICE

## Papers for the Ferry

**Key encounter, one step harder** than hard: pay silver, baht, coins or 2 Food, or take it by force (a fight **one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A clerk sells the stamp that gets a family onto the ferry. **The stamp costs more than you have.**



SEARCH · VIENTI... CHAO FA

KEY ENCOUNTER · WAIT FOR DARK

## The Night Bus Driver

**Key encounter, one step harder** than hard: take it; everyone eats 1 Food, and on a **Fortune card** of 1 to 8 a patrol comes (**one step up**). Or leave it at the bottom of this deck. Win it: recover the next missing square.

A driver who takes people to the river town after dark. **He only drives when the road is empty.**



SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

## A patrol finds you

**Easy fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.



SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

## A patrol finds you

**Easy fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.



SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

## A patrol finds you

**Easy fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.



SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

## A patrol finds you

**Easy fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.



SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · EASY

## A patrol finds you

**Easy fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 1 time **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 59 of 104

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEARCH · THE LOWLANDS

Vientiane Plain

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

## A patrol finds you

**Medium fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 6/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

## A patrol finds you

**Medium fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 7/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

## A patrol finds you

**Medium fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 8/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

## A patrol finds you

**Medium fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 9/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · MEDIUM

## A patrol finds you

**Medium fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 2 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 10/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

## A patrol finds you

**Hard fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 11/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

## A patrol finds you

**Hard fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 12/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

## A patrol finds you

**Hard fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 13/85

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

## A patrol finds you

**Hard fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 14/85

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 61 of 104

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

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CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · PATROL CHAO FA

PATROL · HARD

## A patrol finds you

**Hard fight** now, wherever the party is. Win and search the place 3 times **in safety**.

Soldiers or militia sweep the area where you are.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 15/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

## Food +3

+3 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 16/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

## Food +3

+3 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 17/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

## Food +2

+2 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 18/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

## Food +2

+2 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 19/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

## Food +2

+2 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 20/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

## Food +1

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 21/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

## Food +1

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 22/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD

## Food +1

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 23/85

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD
**Food +1**

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 24/85

SEASON · FOOD CHAO FA

FOOD
**Food +1**

+1 Food now (**max 20**).

Friends, luck or a good harvest.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 25/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
**DEF +3**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +3 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 26/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
**DEF +2**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 27/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
**DEF +2**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 28/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
**DEF +1**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +1 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 29/85

SEASON · SHELTER CHAO FA

SHELTER
**DEF +1**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +1 DEF in the **next fight**.

A place to hide for a while.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 30/85

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
**HP +3**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +3 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 31/85

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
**HP +2**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 32/85

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 65 of 104

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
**HP +2**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +2 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 33/85

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
**HP +1**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +1 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 34/85

SEASON · REMEDY CHAO FA

REMEDY
**HP +1**

Goes to a player's hand. Play it (1 action) for +1 HP in the **next fight**.

Rest and care.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 35/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
**The Army Advances**

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 36/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
**The Army Advances**

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 37/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
**The Army Advances**

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 38/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
**The Army Advances**

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 39/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
**The Army Advances**

The season is lost: move the time marker forward 1 season. In Winter, the party hides instead (as A Sweep Through the Hills).

The war moves faster than you. The army takes the next valley.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 40/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME
**A Sweep Through the Hills**

This season everyone has 1 action and the party cannot Travel.

Soldiers comb the ridges. The family lies still under the leaves.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 41/85

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 67 of 104

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

## A Sweep Through the Hills

This season everyone has 1 action and the party cannot Travel.

Soldiers comb the ridges. The family lies still under the leaves.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 42/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

## A Sweep Through the Hills

This season everyone has 1 action and the party cannot Travel.

Soldiers comb the ridges. The family lies still under the leaves.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 43/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

## A Quiet Spell

This season Travel is safe (no Danger draw) and no one is spotted while foraging.

The soldiers are busy elsewhere.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 44/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SUMMER 1976

HISTORY

## Yellow Rain

Each person draws a **Fortune card**: on 4 or less they fall **Sick** (if already **Sick**, they take **a wound**).

Aircraft pass low over the ridge. Refugees later told of a yellow substance falling, and of sickness and deaths after. What it was is still disputed.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 45/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SPRING 1977

HISTORY

## The Offensive on Phou Bia

The party loses **half its Food** (rounded up), and a **Medium patrol** finds you.

Lao and Vietnamese troops sweep the mountains where the resistance holds out. Villages and rice fields are burned.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 46/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SUMMER 1975

HISTORY

## A Voice on the Radio

Lose 1 Hope. Then, if Hope is 2 or less, the most hurt villager goes down to **surrender** and leaves the party.

A radio voice speaking Hmong promises rice, land and forgiveness to anyone who comes down from the mountains. Some did. Many officers who went down were sent to camps and never came back.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 47/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SUMMER 1975

HISTORY

## A Voice on the Radio

Lose 1 Hope. Then, if Hope is 2 or less, the most hurt villager goes down to **surrender** and leaves the party.

A radio voice speaking Hmong promises rice, land and forgiveness to anyone who comes down from the mountains. Some did. Many officers who went down were sent to camps and never came back.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 48/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

HISTORY

## Betrayed

A **Medium patrol** finds you. If you have a Guide, the Guide was the traitor: lose the Guide card, and the patrol is Hard.

Someone has told the soldiers where you sleep. Hmong fought on both sides of this war, and some guided the soldiers who hunted their own people.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 49/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

HISTORY

## Betrayed

A **Medium patrol** finds you. If you have a Guide, the Guide was the traitor: lose the Guide card, and the patrol is Hard.

Someone has told the soldiers where you sleep. Hmong fought on both sides of this war, and some guided the soldiers who hunted their own people.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 50/85

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 69 of 104

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · HISTO… CHAO FA

HISTORY

## Bombs in the Grass

**Each person draws a Fortune card: on 2 or less they step on one and take 2 wounds.**

The path crosses ground bombed in the war. Small round bomblets lie in the grass and mud, and nearly one in three never went off.



SEASON · HISTO… CHAO FA

HISTORY

## Bombs in the Grass

**Each person draws a Fortune card: on 2 or less they step on one and take 2 wounds.**

The path crosses ground bombed in the war. Small round bomblets lie in the grass and mud, and nearly one in three never went off.



SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## A Wounded Soldier

A wounded man from the resistance crawls into your camp and asks to come with you.

**Take him in.** Share your food. He knows where a cache is hidden, but the soldiers hunting him may follow.

−3 Food, +1 Hope, 1 safe search, Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight

**Leave him.** You cannot feed another mouth, and soldiers may be tracking him.

−1 Hope



SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## A Lao Family's Granary

A lowland family has a full rice granary. Your children are hungry.

**Take rice at night.** Fill your baskets and hope no one wakes.

+3 Food, −1 Hope, Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight

**Ask to trade.** Offer something you carry. They give what they can spare.

+2 Food, give up an item



SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## Another Family

A mother and two children beg to travel with you. They have nothing.

**Welcome them.** They share your fire and your rice until they find their own people.

−3 Food, +2 Hope

**Turn them away.** Every mouth slows the party.

−2 Hope



SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## Fever in the Night

A child is burning with fever. Your medicine is almost gone.

**Use the medicine.** Give up a healing item, if you have one, to bring the fever down.

+1 Hope, give up an item, a sick or wounded person recovers

**Call the spirits and wait.** The shaman sits with the child through the night. The fever breaks at dawn, but the child is weak.

+1 Hope, someone takes 1 wound



SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## An Abandoned Harvest

A field of ripe rice, its owners gone. Soldiers patrol the valley by day.

**Harvest by day.** Take as much as you can carry.

+4 Food, Fortune card of 10 or less: hard fight

**Glean at night.** Take only what you can find in the dark.

+2 Food



SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## Hmong New Year

It is the New Year (Noj Peb Caug). In the village there would be feasting, ball games and new clothes.

**Celebrate quietly.** Cook a little extra and tell the old stories.

−2 Food, +2 Hope

**Let it pass.** There is no food to spare. You promise to celebrate on the other side.

no effect



SEASON · DILEM… CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## Rumours of the Trail

A traveller says the way ahead is watched. Someone could go ahead alone to look.

**Send a scout.** The scout comes back hurt but knows the way.

someone takes 1 wound, turn up the next row

**Go on blind.** Trust the trail.

no effect



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 71 of 104

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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Season

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

UNTIL SUMMER 1975

DILEMMA

## The March to Vientiane

Spring 1975. Thousands of Hmong are walking toward Vientiane, hoping to reach the Mekong together. Ahead, at the Hin Heup bridge, soldiers wait.

**Walk with the crowd.** There is safety in numbers, until the shooting starts.

+1 Hope, turn up the next row, Fortune card of 10 or less: hard fight

**Keep to the forest.** Turn back into the hills, alone.

−1 Hope

THE TRAIL SEASON · 60/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## A Crying Child

Soldiers are on the path below and a child will not stop crying. Many parents gave babies opium so their crying would not give the family away; some children died of it.

**Quiet the child with opium.** The crying stops. The child sleeps too long and wakes weak.

someone takes 1 wound

**Hold the child and run.** Carry the child and break for cover before the soldiers come.

−1 Hope, Fortune card of 10 or less: medium fight

THE TRAIL SEASON · 61/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## The Rooster Will Crow

The family must move tonight. A rooster crows at dawn and a dog barks at strangers. One boy had to leave his pet rooster behind for this reason.

**Leave the animals behind.** Let them go in the forest. The children cry quietly.

−1 Hope, lose your animals

**Keep them close.** Hold the beaks and muzzles and hope.

Fortune card of 10 or less: medium fight

THE TRAIL SEASON · 62/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

FROM FALL 1975

DILEMMA

## The Chao Fa

Armed men with long hair stop you on the ridge: a Chao Fa band. They offer to let your family hide with them, but the army hunts them hardest.

**Hide with them a while.** They share what they know of the forest. Then the soldiers come.

−2 Food, +1 Hope, 1 safe search, Fortune card of 10 or less: hard fight

**Keep to your own way.** Thank them and walk on alone.

no effect

THE TRAIL SEASON · 63/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## Leaflets of Amnesty

Planes drop leaflets: those who come down from the mountains will be forgiven. Many who went were sent to re-education camps.

**Stay hidden.** Tear up the leaflets and keep going.

−1 Hope

**Argue about it all night.** The family is divided and no one sleeps.

+1 Food, −2 Hope

THE TRAIL SEASON · 64/85

SEASON · AMBUSH CHAO FA

AMBUSH

## Ambush on the Trail

A **Medium fight**: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in the first clash).

Shots from above the path. The soldiers were waiting.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 65/85

SEASON · AMBUSH CHAO FA

AMBUSH

## Ambush on the Trail

A **Medium fight**: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in the first clash).

Shots from above the path. The soldiers were waiting.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 66/85

SEASON · AMBUSH CHAO FA

AMBUSH

## Ambush on the Trail

A **Medium fight**: the soldiers **fire first** (you deal nothing in the first clash).

Shots from above the path. The soldiers were waiting.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 67/85

SEASON · FOG CHAO FA

FOG

## Fog in the Valley

Gain a Fog card: discard it to avoid one fight (not the River Patrol).

A thick fog fills the valley for days.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 68/85

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 73 of 104

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

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Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · FOG CHAO FA

FOG

## Fog in the Valley

Gain a Fog card: discard it to avoid one fight (not the River Patrol).

A thick fog fills the valley for days.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 69/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## Smoke on the Far Ridge

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

A village is burning across the valley. Is it yours?

THE TRAIL SEASON · 70/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## Smoke on the Far Ridge

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

A village is burning across the valley. Is it yours?

THE TRAIL SEASON · 71/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## Dogs Bark All Night

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

Somewhere below, the dogs will not settle.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 72/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## Dogs Bark All Night

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

Somewhere below, the dogs will not settle.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 73/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## A Spotter Plane

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

A small plane circles twice and goes away.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 74/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## A Spotter Plane

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

A small plane circles twice and goes away.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 75/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## The Grandmother's Dream

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

She dreamed of a river and a white horse. No one sleeps after that.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 76/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## The Grandmother's Dream

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

She dreamed of a river and a white horse. No one sleeps after that.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 77/85

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

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LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LJB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## Footprints That Are Not Ours

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

Someone else walked this path in the night.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 78/85

SEASON · OMEN CHAO FA

OMEN

## Footprints That Are Not Ours

Keep it face up. Draw a **Fortune card**: on 5 times the number of Omens face up or less, the Turning Point comes. Draw one Turning Point card at random.

Someone else walked this path in the night.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 79/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

## The Burning Season

This season every Danger draw when the party Travels is 2 better, and no one can Forage (Spring only).

Smoke from the swidden fires hangs over every valley. Nothing can be seen from far, and nothing grows in the ash.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 80/85

SEASON · TIME CHAO FA

TIME

## The Burning Season

This season every Danger draw when the party Travels is 2 better, and no one can Forage (Spring only).

Smoke from the swidden fires hangs over every valley. Nothing can be seen from far, and nothing grows in the ash.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 81/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SUMMER 1975

HISTORY

## A Child Is Born

**Hope +1**. One adult goes **Hungry** this Winter. The baby is not a villager and cannot be lost.

A baby is born on the trail, in a shelter of leaves, and lives.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 82/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM SPRING 1976

HISTORY

## A Letter from America

**Hope +1**, and turn face up every place in the river row.

A letter, passed from hand to hand for months, from a relative already resettled. The river is the way.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 83/85

SEASON · HISTO... CHAO FA

FROM FALL 1975

HISTORY

## The Writing of the Chao Fa

If the party holds the Book or the Pahawh Primer: **Hope +1** and one safe search here. Otherwise nothing.

A fighter shows you the script of Shong Lue Yang, the Mother of Writing, which the Chao Fa carry as their own.

THE TRAIL SEASON · 84/85

SEASON · DILEM... CHAO FA

DILEMMA

## The Elder's Choice

The oldest of you, hungry and slow, asks to stay behind at this place so the young can move faster.

**Stay together.** No one is left. Every Danger draw is 1 worse until the next Winter.

no effect

**Let him stay.** He keeps a little rice and the fire. He is still in Laos. No Hope is lost, and his things pass to the party.

no effect

THE TRAIL SEASON · 85/85

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## A Lao Trader

A trader with a pole and two baskets stops to rest. He looks at what you carry.

**Trade with him.** Give up an item for rice and salt.

+4 Food, give up an item

**Let him go.** He might talk.

no effect

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 1/13

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 77 of 104

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

LUB CAIJ · DRAW ONE EACH SEASON

Season

CHAO FA

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## A Widow and Her Son

A Hmong widow and her small son have been hiding alone since the spring (Lee clan).

**Take them with you.** More mouths, but she knows the forest paths.

−3 Food, +1 Hope, turn up the next row

**Give them what you can spare.** A little rice and directions.

−1 Food, +1 Hope



STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## A Deserter

A young soldier from the other side, without his rifle, wants to sell what he knows.

**Pay him.** He tells you where the patrols are.

give up an item, gain an escape card

**Drive him off.** He may go back to his unit.

Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight



STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## A Forest Monk

A Lao monk lives alone in a hut by the path. He has rice and a little medicine.

**Ask for medicine.** He tends your sick.

+1 Hope, a sick or wounded person recovers

**Ask for rice.** He shares his bowl.

+2 Food



STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## Hmong Hunters

Two hunters from another clan are out for deer. They know these hills (Vang clan).

**Hunt with them.** Share the work and the meat.

+3 Food, Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight

**Ask the way.** They draw the paths in the dirt.

turn up the next row



STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## A Friendly Headman

A village headman smiles, offers rice and asks where you are going.

**Tell him the truth.** He may be a friend. He may not.

+2 Food, Fortune card of 10 or less: medium fight

**Lie and leave at night.** Hungry, but unseen.

−1 Hope



STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## A Dying Fighter

An old resistance fighter, too sick to walk, says he hid things in this place.

**Stay with him to the end.** He tells you where to dig.

−1 Food, −1 Hope, 2 safe searches

**Leave him your water.** You go on.

−1 Hope



STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## Lost Children

Three children whose parents were shot at the river are hiding in a hollow tree.

**Take them.** They slow you, but how could you not?

−3 Food, +2 Hope

**Show them the way to a village.** Lao farmers may take them in.

−2 Hope



STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## An Opium Smuggler

A smuggler with a pack pony knows the back ways to the river, for silver.

**Hire him.** Pay, and he shows a hidden path.

give up an item, turn up the next row, gain an escape card

**Keep away.** Smugglers attract soldiers.

no effect



STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## A Txiv Neeb on the Trail

A shaman travelling to a sick relative offers to call your souls home (Yang clan).

**Hold a ceremony.** Kill your last chicken and call the souls.

−1 Food, +2 Hope, a sick or wounded person recovers

**Thank him.** He blesses the children as he passes.

+1 Hope



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 79 of 104

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## Militia at the Spring

Village militia are filling their water at the spring you need.

**Wait them out.** Lie still until dark.
−1 Food

**Rush them.** Take their water and their gear.
1 safe search, Fortune card of 10 or less: easy fight

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 11/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## Men Around a Radio

Hmong men in a clearing listen to a radio from Thailand. Names of the people in the camps are read out.

**Listen with them.** You hear a cousin's name. He made it.
+2 Hope

**Ask for news of the river.** They tell you which crossings are watched.
+1 Hope, turn up the next row

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 12/13

STRANGER · SEE... CHAO FA

STRANGER

## A Lao Boatman

A lowland fisherman mending nets says he has taken Hmong families across before, and asks for nothing.

**Accept his help.** He will wait for you at the Fishing Hamlet.
+1 Hope

**Keep away.** You trust no one now.
no effect

THE TRAIL STRANGER · 13/13

STORY CLOTH · 1... CHAO FA

1961 TO 1975 · BEFORE

## The Village

**Read it aloud** when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Families farmed the mountain slopes. From 1961 the men were recruited into a secret army; by 1969 it counted about 39,000, and planes dropped rice to the hill airstrips when the fields could no longer be farmed.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 1/9

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

MAY 1975 · LEFT BEHIND

## The Last Planes

**Read it aloud** when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

On 14 May 1975 about 2,500 officers and their families were flown out of Long Tieng. Most soldiers and their families were left at their posts and had to walk.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 2/9

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

1975 ONWARD · THE NEW GOVERNMENT

## The Soldiers Come

**Read it aloud** when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Many officers and officials were sent to re-education "seminars" in remote camps, where many were starved or worked to death. At the Hin Heup bridge, soldiers fired on Hmong marching toward Vientiane.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 3/9

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

1975 TO 1976 · PHOU BIA

## Into the Forest

**Read it aloud** when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Others went into the forest. Former soldiers joined the Chao Fa, and Phou Bia, the highest mountain in Laos, became their stronghold. Whole villages hid with them.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 4/9

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

1975 TO 1980 · IN THE JUNGLE

## Hiding

**Read it aloud** when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Families hid in the jungle with the fighters and moved on whenever the soldiers came close. One oral history speaks of more than 100,000 people in the jungles.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 5/9

STORY CLOTH · ... CHAO FA

1977 TO 1978 · THE OFFENSIVES

## Fire from the Sky

**Read it aloud** when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Vietnamese regiments were sent against Phou Bia, and thousands were killed or captured. Refugees told of "yellow rain" from aircraft; what it was is still disputed.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 6/9

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 81 of 104

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

QHUA · SEEK HELP

Stranger

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 3

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 2

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 1

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 6

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 5

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

Square 4

CHAO FA

STORY CLOTH · 7… CHAO FA

1975 TO 1980 · THE WAY OUT

## The Walk South

**Read it aloud** when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Families walked for weeks toward the Mekong, carrying children and what they could. Up to a third of the Hmong of Laos left the country.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 7/9

STORY CLOTH · … CHAO FA

1975 TO 1992 · THE MEKONG

## The Crossing

**Read it aloud** when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

They crossed at night on bamboo floats, rafts or hired boats, and were shot at from the Lao bank. No one counted how many drowned. UNHCR counted 211,344 people from Laos reaching Thailand from 1975 to 1979.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 8/9

STORY CLOTH · … CHAO FA

1975 TO 1992 · BAN VINAI

## The Camp

**Read it aloud** when found. Its carrier keeps it; if they are killed or taken, shuffle it into the top 3 of that place's search deck as a fallen square.

Ban Vinai held 42,858 people at its peak, 90 percent of them Hmong, and families waited years for a country to take them. In the Thai camps they began to stitch story cloths like this one, so the story would not be lost.

THE TRAIL STORY CLOTH · 9/9

FORTUNE · 1 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Dab phem

In a fight: the soldiers' ATK is +2 this clash.

# 1

*An ill spirit walks. Nothing goes right tonight.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 1/20

FORTUNE · 2 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Ntuj tsaus

In a fight: the soldiers' ATK is +2 this clash.

# 2

*A dark sky. The rain hides the soldiers, not you.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 2/20

FORTUNE · 3 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Huab cua phem

In a fight: the soldiers' ATK is +2 this clash.

# 3

*Bad weather. The path turns to mud under your feet.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 3/20

FORTUNE · 4 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Ib lub suab

In a fight: the soldiers' ATK is +2 this clash.

# 4

*A sound. A twig snaps, and someone heard it.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 4/20

FORTUNE · 5 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Hmoov phem

In a fight: an even clash.

# 5

*Ill luck. The elders would have waited a day.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 5/20

FORTUNE · 6 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Hnub tsis tawm

In a fight: an even clash.

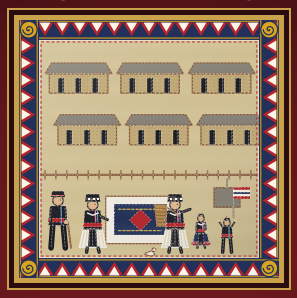
# 6

*The sun does not come out. A grey morning, a grey mood.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 6/20

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 83 of 104

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3



## Square 9

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

## Square 8

CHAO FA

PAJ NTAUB DAB NEEG · 3 × 3

## Square 7

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

## Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

## Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

## Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

## Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

## Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

## Fortune

CHAO FA

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 84 of 104

FORTUNE · 7 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Tsis zoo

In a fight: an even clash.

# 7

*Not good, not yet lost.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 7/20

FORTUNE · 8 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Nco tsev

In a fight: an even clash.

# 8

*Homesick. You remember the village for a moment, and lose the trail.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 8/20

FORTUNE · 9 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Ua siab ntev

In a fight: an even clash.

# 9

*Be patient. The hour is neither for you nor against you.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 9/20

FORTUNE · 10 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Kev khwv

In a fight: an even clash.

# 10

*Hard work, as every day.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 10/20

FORTUNE · 11 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Mus ntsiag to

In a fight: an even clash.

# 11

*Go quietly. The hills keep your secret.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 11/20

FORTUNE · 12 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Ib txoj kev

In a fight: an even clash.

# 12

*One path among many. It will do.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 12/20

FORTUNE · 13 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Cov me nyuam luag

In a fight: an even clash.

# 13

*The children laugh. Everyone walks a little lighter.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 13/20

FORTUNE · 14 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Noj mov

In a fight: an even clash.

# 14

*A warm meal, and strength for the morning.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 14/20

FORTUNE · 15 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Pom kev

In a fight: an even clash.

# 15

*You see the way ahead between the trees.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 15/20

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 85 of 104

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 86 of 104

FORTUNE · 16 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Siab tawv

In a fight: an even clash.

# 16

*A brave heart. Courage runs through the party.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 16/20

FORTUNE · 17 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Ntuj pab

★ In a fight: the party's ATK is +2 this clash.

# 17

*Heaven helps. The soldiers look the wrong way.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 17/20

FORTUNE · 18 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Hmoov zoo

★ In a fight: the party's ATK is +2 this clash.

# 18

*Good fortune. The old sayings were right.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 18/20

FORTUNE · 19 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Qeej nrov

★ In a fight: the party's ATK is +2 this clash.

# 19

*A qeej plays somewhere far off, and the spirits listen.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 19/20

FORTUNE · 20 OF 20 CHAO FA

FORTUNE · HMOOV

## Cob Fab

★ In a fight: the party's ATK is +2 this clash.

# 20

*The Lord of the Sky rides. Nothing can touch you today.*

THE TRAIL FORTUNE · 20/20

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD

## Slack Water

Current check 6 better.

For a moment the great river is almost still.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 1/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD

## Slack Water

Current check 6 better.

For a moment the great river is almost still.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 2/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD

## The Current

The usual current check.

The Mekong pulls hard toward the south, as it always does.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 3/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD

## The Current

The usual current check.

The Mekong pulls hard toward the south, as it always does.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 4/21

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 87 of 104

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

RESHUFFLE ONLY WHEN IT RUNS OUT

Fortune

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## The Current

The usual current check.

The Mekong pulls hard toward the south, as it always does.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 5/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## A Drifting Log

**Hold on to it:** It carries you across, far downstream. You let go of everything you carry.

**Let it go:** The usual current check.

A log turns slowly past in the dark.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 6/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## The Searchlight

**Dive and hold your breath:** Current check 3 worse.

**Lie still in the reeds:** They may see you: Fortune 1–2 killed, 3–4 wounded (+4 under fire). Then the usual current check.

A patrol boat sweeps its light across the water.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 7/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## The Searchlight

**Dive and hold your breath:** Current check 3 worse.

**Lie still in the reeds:** They may see you: Fortune 1–2 killed, 3–4 wounded (+4 under fire). Then the usual current check.

A patrol boat sweeps its light across the water.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 8/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## The Whirlpool

**Throw a rope or float:** Spend a Rattan Rope, Bamboo Floats or an Inner Tube: you are pulled clear and cross.

**Fight it alone:** The river takes you: the drowning check.

The water turns in a circle and pulls down.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 9/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## Cramp

**Someone across swims back:** The strongest one already across goes back in: their current check 2 worse. Pass and both reach the bank; fail and both are swept away.

**Float and pray:** Swept away, but floating: the drowning check 2 better.

Legs lock in the cold water. A child cries out, or an old man stops swimming.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 10/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## A Sandbar

Current check 4 better.

Halfway across, sand under your feet. You can rest.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 11/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## Thai Fishermen

They pull you aboard and you cross. Under fire they turn back: the usual current check.

A small boat puts out from the Thai bank to meet you.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 12/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## The Raft Comes Apart

Current check 2 worse, and everyone still to cross on the raft must swim.

The bamboo lashings slip loose one by one.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 13/21

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 89 of 104

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

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DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 90 of 104

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## Cold Water

Current check 1 worse; 4 worse for a child, elder, sick or wounded person.

The river is colder than anyone expected.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 14/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## A Rain Squall

The usual current check, and no one else is shot going down to the water.

Rain comes down so hard the patrol cannot see the river.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 15/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## A Line from the Thai Bank

Current check 8 better.

People on the far bank have seen you and throw a rope.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 16/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## The Machine Gun

**Swim under the water:** Current check 4 worse.

**Swim fast on the surface:** Fortune 1–2 killed, 3–4 wounded (+4 under fire). Then the usual current check.

The patrol on the Lao bank opens fire into the water.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 17/21

RIVER · MONSOON CHAO FA

RIVER CARD · ADD IN THE MONSOON
## Flood Surge

Current check 5 worse.

A wall of brown water comes down the river.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 18/21

RIVER · MONSOON CHAO FA

RIVER CARD · ADD IN THE MONSOON
## Flood Surge

Current check 5 worse.

A wall of brown water comes down the river.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 19/21

RIVER · MONSOON CHAO FA

RIVER CARD · ADD IN THE MONSOON
## An Uprooted Tree

**Hold on to the tree:** It carries you across. You let go of everything you carry.

**Swim clear of it:** Current check 4 worse.

A whole tree comes down the flood, roots and all.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 20/21

RIVER CHAO FA

RIVER CARD
## Pushed Back

Current check 4 worse.

Thai soldiers on the far bank wave you off: the camps are full. You must land further down, in the dark.

THE TRAIL RIVER · 21/21

TURNING POINT CHAO FA

TURNING POINT
## Hunted

For the rest of the game every Danger draw when the party Travels is 2 worse, but every fight you win gives 1 more safe search.

The army has learned your family's names. Patrols carry a list.

THE TRAIL TURNING POINT · 1/6

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 91 of 104

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

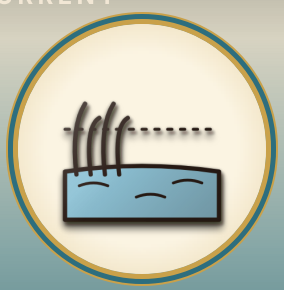
CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT

River

CHAO FA

DEJ · ONE PER PERSON AT THE CURRENT



River

CHAO FA

CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 92 of 104

TURNING POINT

## Sickness Spreads

**Each villager draws a Fortune card: on 8 or less they fall Sick.**

Dysentery runs through the people hiding in the hills.

TURNING POINT

## Word From Thailand

**The passage needs 1 piece fewer. A Boatman waits at the Fishing Hamlet.**

A message comes from a cousin in the camps: a fisherman at the hamlet will take you across.

TURNING POINT

## The Long Rains

**For the rest of the game the river is also in flood in Spring. Summer Forage finds 1 more Food everywhere.**

The rains come early and stay late. The river rises and stays high.

TURNING POINT

## Someone Is Following

**The next time the party Travels, draw a Fortune card. On 10 or less he leads soldiers to you (a Hard fight). On 11 or more he is a Hmong man running too, and he joins you as a Guide.**

A man has been walking behind you for two days, never closer, never gone.

TURNING POINT

## The Mountain Falls

**Every square still guarded is now On the Fallen. Soldiers everywhere use the "from 1977" row. Hope +1 for the families now walking with you.**

Spring 1978. The army takes Phou Bia, and the families who hid there come down the paths behind you.

ENDING A · CARD 1 OF 3

## Across the Mekong

The survivors climb the Thai bank. Like the families who really made this crossing, they are taken to a refugee camp such as Ban Vinai or Nong Khai, and wait there for years. Say aloud the names of those who did not reach the river.

*Read on: card 2 of 3.*

ENDING A · CARD 2 OF 3

## Across the Mekong

Now lay out the nine squares of the story cloth, 1 to 9, and read them aloud in order: the whole journey, from the village to the camp, the way the story cloths stitched in the camps kept it.

Most of those who crossed were resettled in the United States, France, Australia, Canada and French Guiana. More than 330,000 people in the United States now identify as Hmong, the largest group around Minneapolis and St. Paul.

*Read on: card 3 of 3.*

ENDING A · CARD 3 OF 3

## Across the Mekong

The ones who did not cross are part of this story too. Turn the page of this ending and read what happened to them.

For what really happened, from the Chao Fa's origins in 1959 to the families still hiding today, read the history in the companion book or the app.

*Based on true stories.*

ENDING B · CARD 1 OF 2

## The ones who stayed

Those still alive turn back into the forest around Phou Bia. They join the people later called the Chao Fa: Hmong who stayed in the jungle after 1975, moving constantly, cut off from schools, clinics and work.

Lay out the squares of the story cloth you recovered and read them. The rest of the story stayed in the hills.

*Read on: card 2 of 2.*



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 93 of 104

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Across the Mekong

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

WHEN THE OMENS COME TRUE

Turning Point

CHAO FA

IF NO ONE CROSSES

The ones who stayed

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Across the Mekong

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Across the Mekong

CHAO FA

ENDING B · CARD 2 OF 2

## The ones who stayed

A Chao Fa leader said in 2018 that if nothing is done, his people "will not die from being killed in direct confrontation, but from starvation." The Lao government denies these accounts.

Many are still there, in hiding.

For what really happened, from the Chao Fa's origins in 1959 to the families still hiding today, read the history in the companion book or the app.

*Based on true stories.*





A TRUE STORY

## Song Ly

*market seller at Long Tieng*

On 14 May 1975 she and her child boarded the last aircraft out of Long Tieng. Her husband, an air traffic controller, missed it. They found each other again within a month at the Nam Phong camp.





A TRUE STORY

## May Lee Soung

*nurse*

She began nursing at Sam Thong hospital at 11 and watched soldiers whose wounds were beyond treatment die in front of her. In 1975 her family went to Vientiane and hired a boat across the Mekong.





A TRUE STORY

## Neng "Nhia Cha" Xiong

*lieutenant, recruited at 15*

After 1975 he hid in the jungle, hunted by the soldiers. In 1979 he swam across the Mekong with his family, and lived at Ban Vinai until the camp closed.





A TRUE STORY

## Youa K. Vue

*survivor*

In 1979 she made a hard choice: to leave her mother and siblings behind. After days of walking her group reached the Mekong and crossed safely. On the way she met and married Xai Chou Xiong, who promised to protect her. Her mother and siblings survived in Laos.





A TRUE STORY

## Sao Ger Xiong

*medic*

His family hid in the jungle so he would not be imprisoned. In October 1979 he, his family and about 250 Hmong risked their lives to cross the Mekong together.





A TRUE STORY

## Cha Ger Moua

*boy soldier*

Two of his brothers were killed, and in 1972 he joined the army as a boy to avenge them. From 1975 his family hid in the jungle. In May 1980 he crossed the Mekong with 361 other Hmong.





A TRUE STORY

## Nhia Ge Vang

*captain*

After 1975 his community was moved into a village where they were ordered to learn the communist way of life. In 1979 he left for Thailand with about 1,000 Hmong.





A TRUE STORY

## Xong Pao Hang

*boy soldier, recruited at 13*

His uniform had to be cut down to fit him. After 1975 his family hid. In 1978, as they fled toward Thailand, his mother and sister were shot dead by the troops pursuing them.



CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 95 of 104

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

CHAO FA

IF NO ONE CROSSES

The ones who stayed

CHAO FA

IF ANYONE CROSSES

Voice

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VOICE · IF NO ONE ... CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

## Xai Chou Xiong

*lieutenant*

After 1975 his family hid in the jungle. Almost all of them were killed in one attack. He survived, and later reached the Thai camps.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 9/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE ... CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

## Chong Neng Lor

*platoon commander*

Some of his soldiers were as young as 12. In 1975 he was sent to a re-education camp. He escaped from a work field into the forest and found his family in the jungle. They crossed in 1983, lived about 20 years in Thailand, and reached the United States in 2004.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 10/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE ... CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

## Nhia Tou Pha

*lieutenant*

When the soldiers were rounded up, his family hid in the jungle. From 1975 to 1979 he fought with the Chao Fa resistance. In 1980 he fled to Ban Vinai.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 11/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE ... CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

## Tong Chang Lee

*captain, wounded three times*

After 1975 he resisted from the jungle. He escaped to Thailand in 1979 and lived in the camps for 25 years, at Ban Vinai and then Wat Tham Krabok. He reached the United States in 2005, with the last wave.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 12/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE ... CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

## Tong Vang

*veteran*

He came back to Long Tieng and found all the planes gone. "If you lived, you live. If you died you died."

THE TRAIL VOICE · 13/14

VOICE · IF NO ONE ... CHAO FA

A TRUE STORY

## Boua Vang Xiong

*soldier*

He kept fighting from 1973 to 1979. In May 1979 he fled to Thailand with his brother, leaving their parents behind.

THE TRAIL VOICE · 14/14

LAW CHAO FA

LAW OF THE PARTY

## Council of Elders

**The elders decide together. At every year end, +1 Hope, but 1 Food is cooked for the council.**

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

THE TRAIL LAW · REF · 1/21

LAW CHAO FA

LAW OF THE PARTY

## Travel by Night

**Every Danger draw when the party moves is 2 better, but each Forage finds 1 less Food.**

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

THE TRAIL LAW · REF · 2/21

LAW CHAO FA

LAW OF THE PARTY

## Proper Funerals

**Deaths cost no Hope, but each burial uses 1 Food for the funeral meal.**

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

THE TRAIL LAW · REF · 3/21

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IF NO ONE CROSSES

Voice

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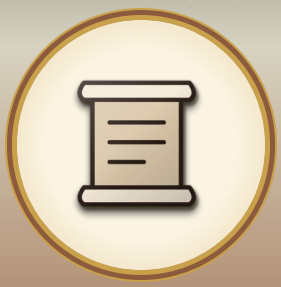
WINTER COUNCIL

Law

CHAO FA

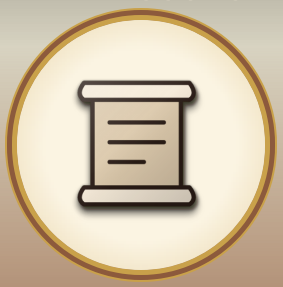
WINTER COUNCIL



Law

CHAO FA

WINTER COUNCIL



Law

CHAO FA

LAW OF THE PARTY

## Everyone Nurses the Sick

**Every Rest heals 1 extra wound or cures Sickness on any card, but each cure uses 1 Food for broth.**

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

LAW OF THE PARTY

## Strict Rations

**In Spring and Summer only half the party (rounded up) eats. -1 Hope at every year end while anyone is hungry.**

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.

LAW OF THE PARTY

## Travel Light

**Each person keeps at most 3 items (discard the rest now). Every Danger draw is 2 better.**

At a Winter council, draw 2 laws; the party may adopt one. It cannot be undone.





REFERENCE

## Waiting, powers and escape · 1 of 3

**When you cannot move** (1 action each): **Lay an ambush** (once a place): next fight here you fire first. **Cover tracks** (once a season): noise here −2. **Trade** (village, hamlet, road, ferry): item for 3 Food, informer on a Fortune card of 1–3. **Share a meal** (once a season): 2 Food, Hope +1. **Seek help** (once a season): draw a Stranger.

**Side A power**: once a season (Old Road, Winter Clothes once a year). **Side B trait**: always on.

**Armor**: stops that much damage to its



REFERENCE

## Waiting, powers and escape · 2 of 3

**Escape card**: when soldiers find you (not the River Patrol), discard it: no fight.

**Omens**: on the Omen row of the board; each new one, a Fortune card at or under the row's number = the Turning Point (draw 1 of 6, once a game).

**Clan**: a Stranger of a clan in the party gives the better answer for nothing.

**Hidden field** (Spring, at the fields, the stream or the Vientiane plain, 1 Food): planted; +4 Food in Fall if you are still there and no fight has happened here.



REFERENCE

## Waiting, powers and escape · 3 of 3

**Animals**: a Horse or Water Buffalo carries one more pack slot and may be slaughtered for 4 Food and −1 Hope; neither goes into the caves or across the river. **Disguise**: two disguise pieces in the party and a Guarded or Price key is not stepped up.





REFERENCE

## A season on the trail · 1 of 3

**Season card**: draw and resolve; answer dilemmas together.

**2 actions each** (1 if Sick; −1 at Hope 0): Search · Scout · Forage · Rest or nurse · Build camp · Side A power · Play a card · Give an item.

**Travel** (first thing in the season, instead of any actions): move the party to a known place next to it, draw a Fortune card against its Danger, gather forage, and the season ends.





REFERENCE

## A season on the trail · 2 of 3

**Hard work eats**: Search, Scout, Build and Travel cost 1 Food (none left: the worker takes a wound). **Winter**: eat 1 Food each; each short is a wound.

Forage: +1 wherever the tile shows any.

**Carry**: 2 hands (rifles, bows and spears take both), 1 body, 1 head, 3 pack. Animals, boats and raft wood are shared. Too much? Hand it on or leave it.

**Unnursed sick**: die on a Fortune card of 1–5.





REFERENCE

## A season on the trail · 3 of 3

**Winter**: the Toll, then draw 2 laws; the council may adopt one.

**Fallen players**: once a season, give a living villager 1 more action.



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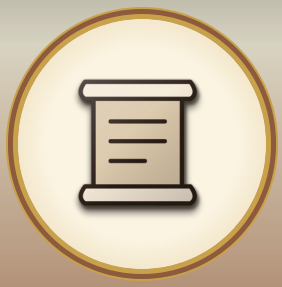
WINTER COUNCIL



Law

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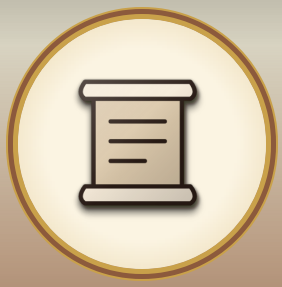
WINTER COUNCIL



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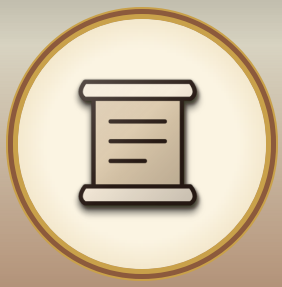
WINTER COUNCIL



Law

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KEEP FACE UP

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CHAO FA · 1 Cards, low ink · sheet 100 of 104

REFERENCE

## Fights and noise · 1 of 3

**1 · The soldiers**: one number from the Patrol table (the row is the fight, the column your living villagers, the block the year) is their ATK, DEF and HP. Nothing is added. Add up the party's ATK, DEF and HP.

**2 · Clash**, up to 3 times: draw 1 Fortune card (1–4: soldiers +2 ATK; 17–20: party +2 ATK). You deal your ATK minus their number; they deal their number minus your DEF, **always at least 1**. You choose who is hit; Armor stops it first.

**3 · The cost**: their damage reaches their number = you win and search here in

REFERENCE · FIGHTS CHAO FA

REFERENCE

## Fights and noise · 2 of 3

**Prisoner**: a villager who falls in a fight (not the river) draws a Fortune card: 1–10 killed, 11–20 taken prisoner (Ending 4). Either way, everything they carried is lost.

**Break away** (after clash 1 or 2): discard one item per living villager instead of taking their hit; the fight ends, nothing gained.

**Shakedown** (Easy fights only): hand over 2 Food or one money item and walk on. No fight.

**Loud weapons**: a fight with any loud weapon puts an Alarm token on the

REFERENCE · FIGHTS CHAO FA

REFERENCE

## Fights and noise · 3 of 3

**Night** (Travel by Night, after moving): the soldiers' number and your ATK are both 1 lower. **A carried child**: the carrier has one hand and ATK −1; the child cannot be hit.

**Noise**: searching a place again, a Fortune card at or under its earlier searches = soldiers (no spoils).





REFERENCE

## The Toll and the river · 1 of 3

**Toll**: each person draws a Fortune card, falls Sick on 5 or less. +1 child, elder, wounded or sick; +1 per Food short (max 3); +cold (1975 0, 76–77 +1, 78–79 +2); Hope 0 +2, 1–2 +1, 5–6 −1; healer −1; finished camp −1; warm items up to −2. Sick and taken again: dies.

**Guard tokens**: when a key encounter is drawn and left, its guard token goes on the tile so the table sees where the keys are.

REFERENCE · WINT… CHAO FA

REFERENCE

## The Toll and the river · 2 of 3

**Keys**: every key is guarded, one step harder than its place (hard → deadly); a win recovers the next square of the story cloth. **River**: need all 9 squares (sewn at the start: a party of 6 has squares 1–2, 5 has 1–3, 4 has 1–4, 3 has 1–5; Short Trail 3 more), on any river place. A fallen carrier's squares go into the top 3 of that place's search deck. 1 Hope lets one person draw again at the current or when drowning. River Patrol: its own row of the Patrol table, no escape cards; up to 3 clashes; still standing = cross under fire (no

REFERENCE · WINT… CHAO FA

REFERENCE

## The Toll and the river · 3 of 3

**Low water** (Spring, not monsoon): the current is 2 better. **The tributary** (lowlands to river, Summer or Fall): a Fortune card, on 1–2 the heaviest load loses an item.

**Boat**: four seats a trip; a second trip meets the River Patrol again. **Washed up**: swept away and drawing 18 or more, you reach the Thai bank alone with nothing.





REFERENCE · 1 OF 3

## Symbol key

**Search**: draw the top card of this place

**Scout**: turn a hidden place face up

**Travel**: the party moves; the season ends

**Rest / Nurse**: heal 1, or break a fever

**Camp**: a finished camp heals 2 and eases the Toll

**Food**: the store; eaten in Winter

**Hope**: 0 to 6; sets the Toll and the actions

**Wound**: −1 HP; at 0 the villager falls

**Sick**: one action; cured by nursing

REFERENCE · SYMB… CHAO FA

REFERENCE · 2 OF 3

## Symbol key

**Danger III / IIII**: Hard and Deadly fights

**River Patrol ~**: the fight at the bank

**Ambush**: the soldiers fire first

**Escape**: discard: no fight

**Fortune 1–4**: soldiers +2 this clash

**Fortune 17–20**: party +2 this clash

**Alarm**: next fight here this season one row harder

**Guard**: a key encounter waits here

**Key**: a square of the story cloth

**Omen**: on the Omen row; brings the Turning Point

REFERENCE · SYMB… CHAO FA

REFERENCE · 3 OF 3

## Symbol key

**Quiet weapon**: no alarm; a hunter fires first

**Cannot swim**: drowns 2 worse without a float

**Money**: pays a Boatman, a Price, a Trade, a shakedown

**Animal**: one more pack slot; 3 Food if slaughtered

**Disguise**: two pieces: no step up at a key

**Cache**: items left on a tile

**Planted field**: harvest +2 Food when you return

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KEEP FACE UP

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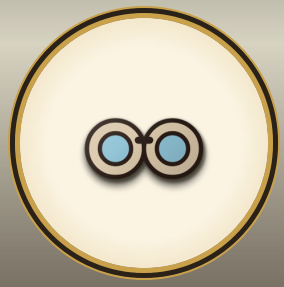

Reference

CHAO FA

SETUP · THE PHOU … CHAO FA

SETUP CARD · A HISTORICAL TRAIL

## The Phou Bia Trail

Lay face down, left to right. **Hills**: Swidden Fields, Plain of Jars, Long Tieng Airstrip. **Jungle**: Phou Bia Slopes, Phou Khao Khouay Jungle, Limestone Caves. **Lowlands**: Lao Farm Village, Nam Xan Valley, Vientiane Plain. **River**: Mekong Reeds, Fishing Hamlet, Tha Deua Ferry.

Far bank: Bueng Kan, then the camp at Ban Vinai.

THE TRAIL SETUP · 1/3

SETUP · THE VIENTI… CHAO FA

SETUP CARD · A HISTORICAL TRAIL

## The Vientiane Road

Lay face down, left to right. **Hills**: Swidden Fields, Pine Ridge, Long Tieng Airstrip. **Jungle**: Bamboo Forest, Phou Khao Khouay Jungle, Limestone Caves. **Lowlands**: Lao Farm Village, Hin Heup Bridge, Vientiane Plain. **River**: Mekong Reeds, Fishing Hamlet, Tha Deua Ferry.

Far bank: Nong Khai, then the camp at Ban Vinai.

THE TRAIL SETUP · 2/3

SCENARIO · THE LA… CHAO FA

SCENARIO · AFTER A GAME

## The Late Crossing, 1979

Spring 1979 (season 17), a lowlands place, the squares you held (at least six). Patrol table face 2 only; Pushed Back in the River deck. Food 2 each, Hope 2. The camps close after season 24.

The villagers alive in Laos at the last Winter try again.

THE TRAIL SETUP · 3/3

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THE LATE CROSSING

Scenario

CHAO FA

THE VIENTIANE ROAD

Setup card

CHAO FA

THE PHOU BIA TRAIL

Setup card

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